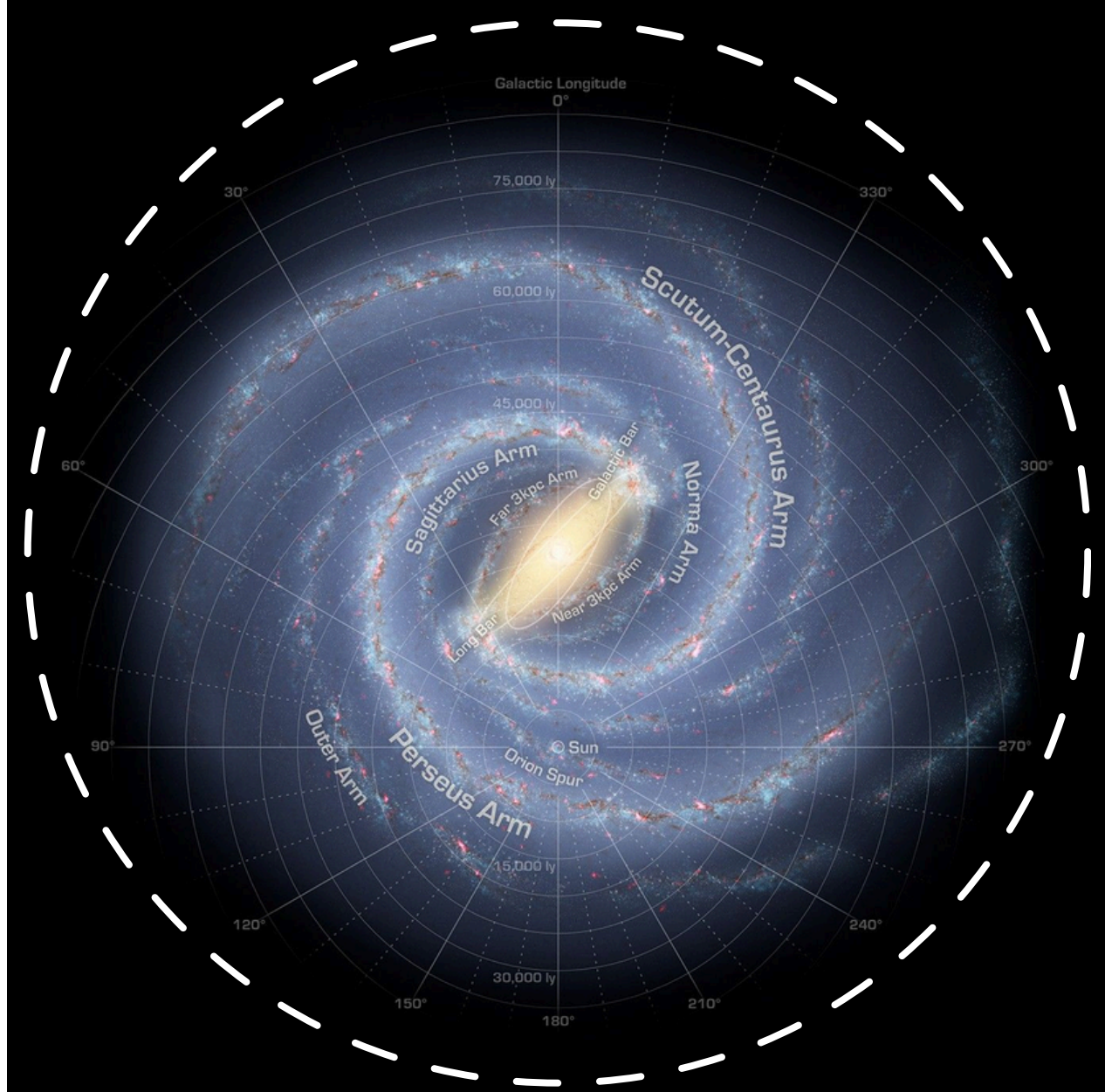




Earth is roughly 26,000 light-years away from the center of the Milky Way on the edge of a spiral arm called the Orion Spur.

There is a supermassive black hole in the center of the Milky Way called Sagittarius A* (Sgr A*)

The Sun takes 225 million years to complete one orbit around the Milky Way spiral disk.

The Milky Way contains a spiral disk, a bulge near the center, and a halo surrounding the whole Galaxy.

MILKY WAY GALAXY FACTS

The Milky Way contains an estimated 200 billion stars. The largest galaxy we know of is called IC 1101 and has over 100 trillion stars.

Scientists estimate the Universe is about 13.8 billion years old and that the Milky Way is about 13.6 billion years old.

Our cosmic address is: Earth, Solar System, Milky Way, Local Group, Virgo Supercluster, Laniakea Supercluster

Our galaxy is made up of about 90% dark matter (cannot be seen) and about 10% luminous matter (can be seen).

The Milky Way is named after an Ancient Greek legend. When Hera was nursing Heracles, he spilled some of the milk and streaked it across the sky.

There are an estimated 100-400 billion stars in our galaxy.

The black hole in the center, Sgr A*, has a mass ~ 4 million times that of the Sun, with a diameter of around 14.6 million miles